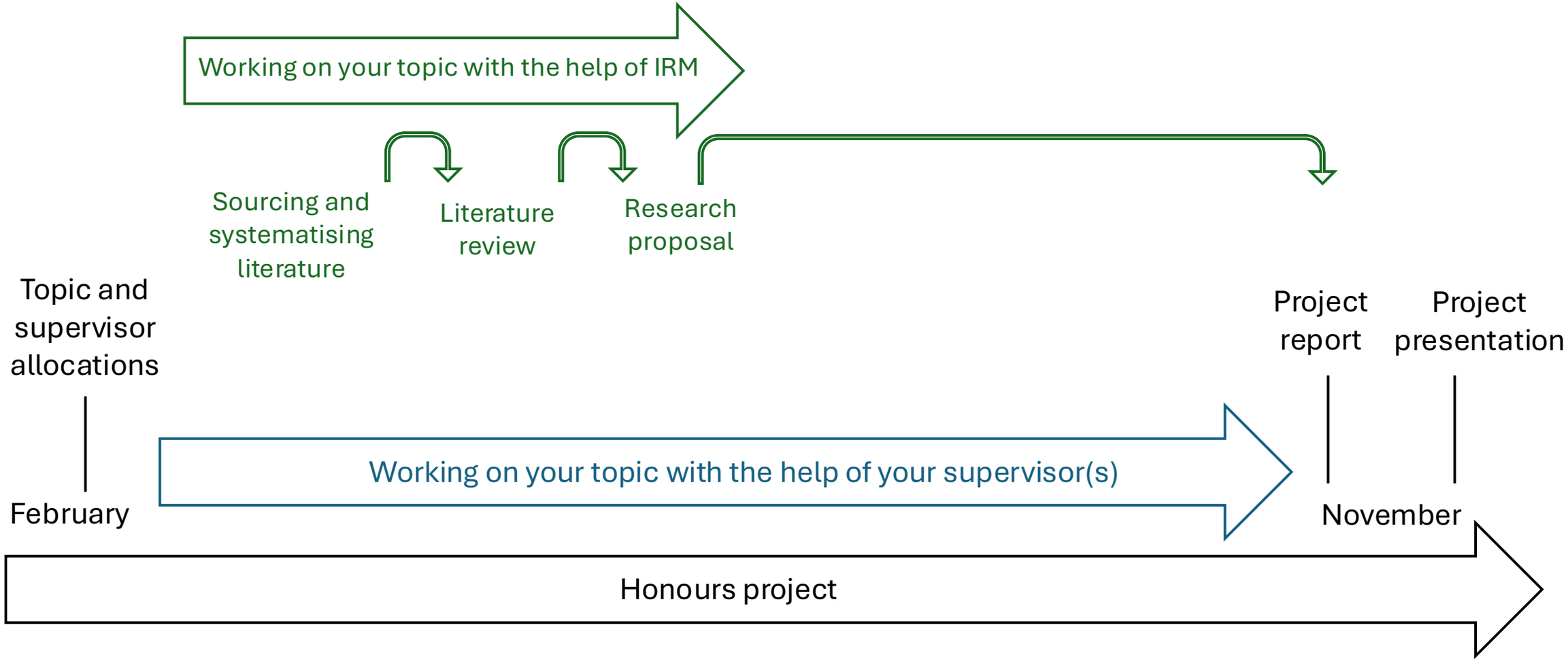
Introduction to Research Methods (IRM)

COMS4057A

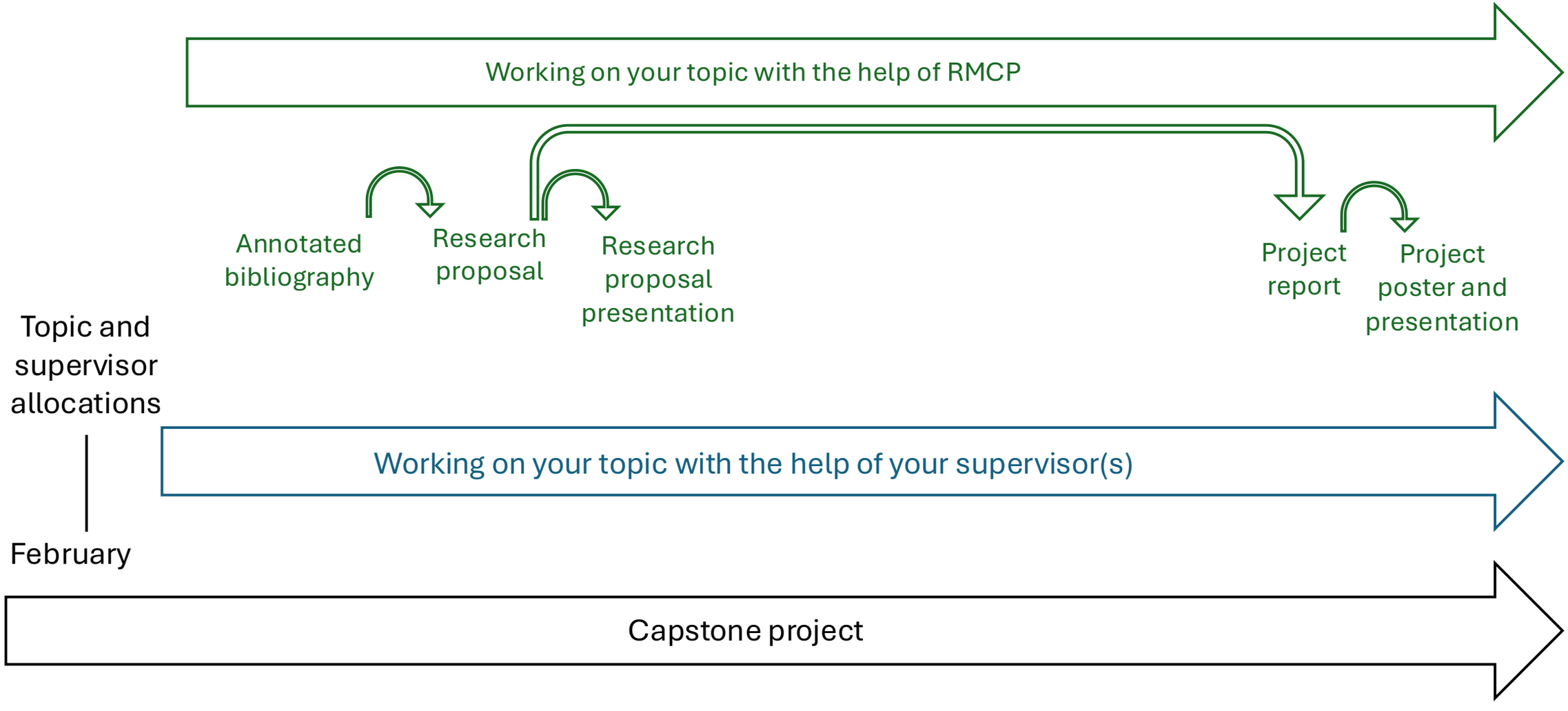
Research Methods and Capstone Project

COMS7060/67/72/73A

What is IRM?


Working on your topic with the help of IRM
Sourcing and systematising literature
Literature review
Research proposal
Topic and supervisor allocations
Project report
Project presentation
Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)
February
November
Honours project

What is RMCP?

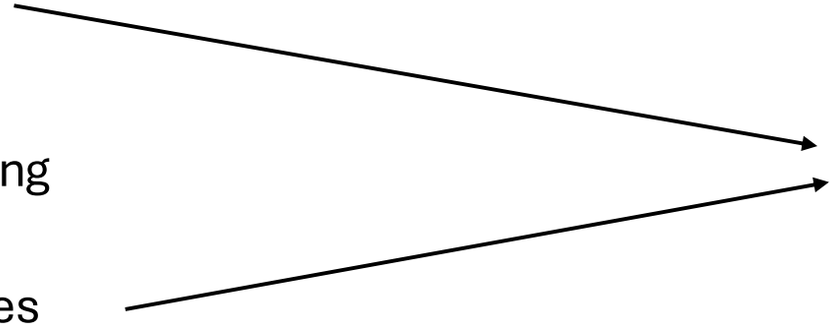

Working on your topic with the help of RMCP
Annotated bibliography
Research proposal
Research proposal presentation
Project report
Project poster and presentation
Topic and supervisor allocations
Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)
February
Capstone project

Some of the topics we'll cover

- Identifying literature relevant to your project
- Reading and systematising literature
- Identifying a research problem
- Formulating a research question
- Writing a literature review
- Formulating a methodology including
    - Identifying assumptions
    - Formulating aims and objectives
    - Formulating a hypothesis
    - Identifying and discussing relevant data sets
    - Evaluating results

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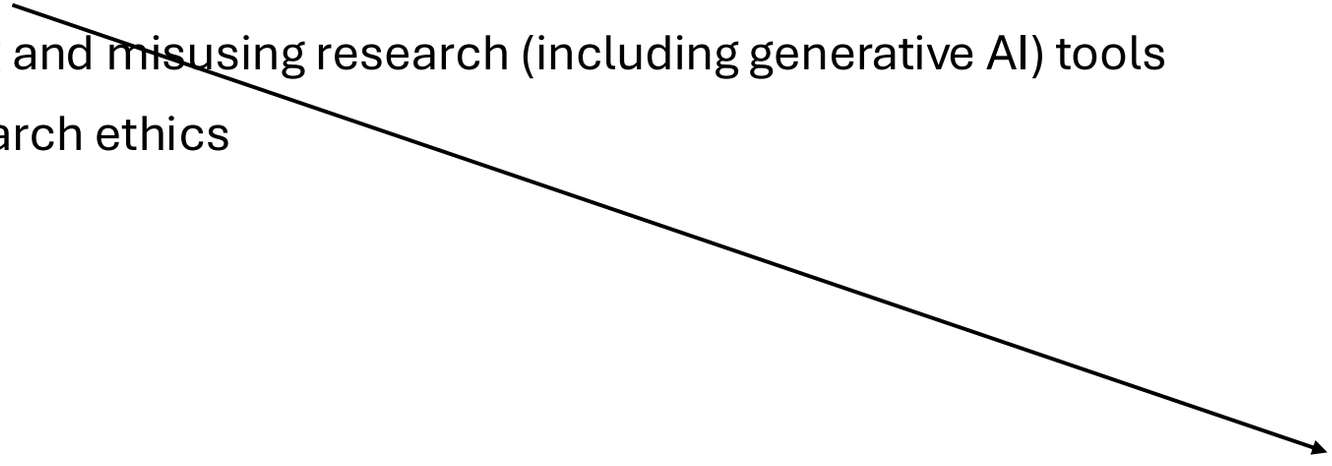
Some of what we will cover will not just be a matter of convention. It will be the pieces that need to fit together for good science.

Some of the topics we'll cover

- Writing a research proposal
- Referencing and plagiarism
- Using and misusing research (including generative AI) tools
- Research ethics

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Some of what we will cover will just be a matter of convention.

Is everything applicable to my project?

- Disciplines and sub-disciplines vary both in terms of their conventions and in terms of the pieces needed for good science.
- Not everything that we cover in each lecture will be applicable to every project, but most of what we cover will be applicable to most projects.
- I will try to point out where something does or doesn’t apply.
- In all cases, your supervisor(s) should be your first and final port of call in terms of your particular project.

Topic and supervisor allocations (February)

- How does it work?
- Topics put forward by supervisors can vary in terms of how narrow and/or detailed they are.

Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)

Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)



Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)



Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)



Working on your topic with the help of your supervisor(s)

You



Working on your topic with the help of your supervisors

- It is an extremely good idea to work on your project as soon as possible and as consistently as possible.
- If you don’t know much about your topic when it’s allocated (and even if you do know a fair bit), the best thing to do is to begin reading about it.
- Supervisors can vary in terms of how they arrange supervision.
- In all cases, it’s a good idea to contact your supervisor soon after the topic is allocated to discuss your supervision with them.

Working on your topic with the help of IRM/RMCP

- There are fixed due dates for submitting your assessments (and penalties if you don’t submit by the due date).
- If you have a good reason why you can’t submit by the due date, you should send me an email as early as possible to discuss a revised due date.
- If your supervisor prefers a different timeline for your submissions, you should also send me an email to discuss this.

Working on your topic with the help of IRM

- Here are my contact details. The best way to contact me usually is via email.

Dr Helen Robertson

Room 21, upper ground floor, TWK MSB

Helen.Robertson@wits.ac.za

011 717 6073

Thank you for attending the lecture.